POSTFLOP FRAMEWORK DRILLS · PLAYER'S GUIDE COMPANION

TACTICAL STACK-SIZE ADJUSTMENTS



How preflop ranges, 3-bets and postflop commitment change from deep stacks to push/fold

THE INVERSE VALUE SEESAW

DEEP STACKS

Suited connectors, small pairs, suited wheel aces

SHALLOW STACKS

Big offsuit cards: KJo, KTo, ATo, A9o, QJo



As stacks get **shorter**, big offsuit cards gain value: they make top pairs you can get all in with. As stacks get **deeper**, suited connectors and small pairs gain value: they make the straights, flushes and sets that win big pots.

One exception at the very short end: once you're shoving, small pairs and weak aces gain value again for their all-in equity and blockers.

WHAT YOUR HANDS ARE FOR

STACK DEPTH

DEEP — SHALLOW

DEEP: MAKING THE NUTS



T9 suited

150bb: T9s is excellent because it makes straights and flushes that can win a 300bb pot. One pair rarely can.

SHALLOW: STRONG TOP PAIRS





KQ offsuit

40–50bb: KQo on K-8-4 is a strong hand. With standard bets it can get all the money in by the river (SPR about 5 at 40bb). In a 3-bet pot at 50bb it is a clear stack-off.

Lojack open · 80bb · your chart

OPENING RANGES: THE DEEP BLUEPRINT

STACK DEPTH

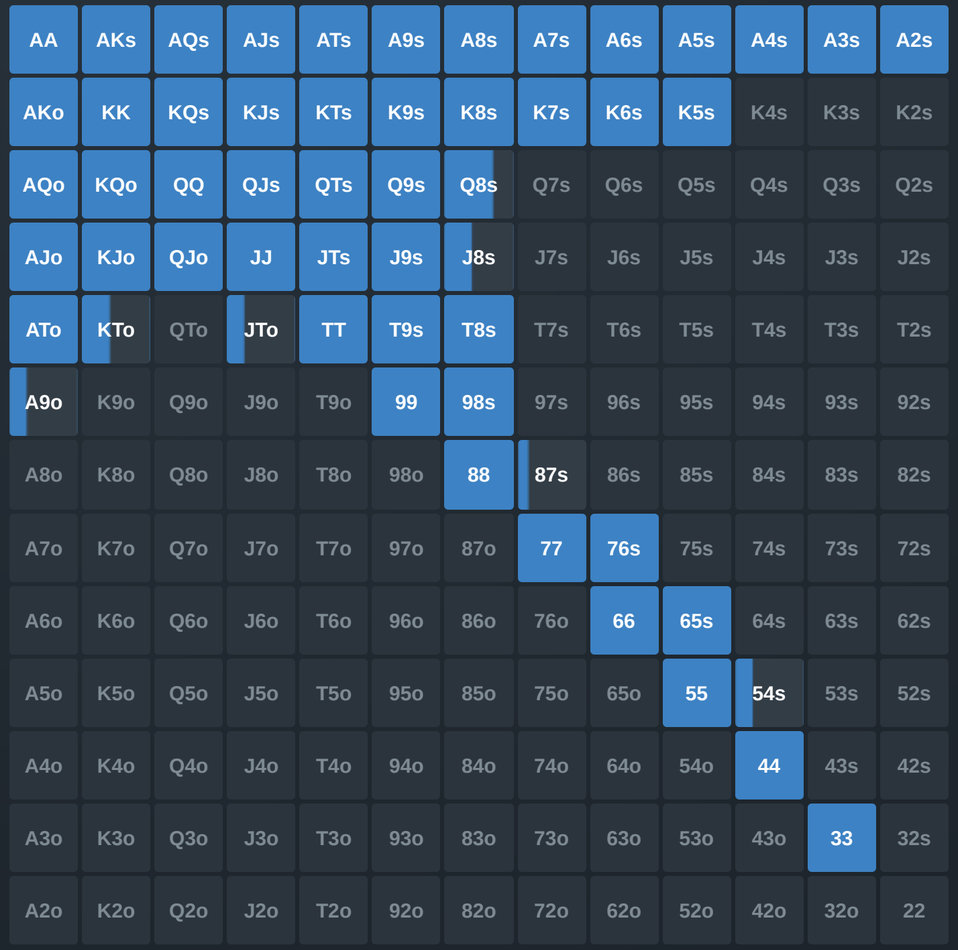
DEEP — SHALLOW

How to read the grid

Pairs on the diagonal, **suited** hands above it, **offsuit** hands below it. Part-filled cells are opened only some of the time.

The offsuit desert

Only 7 offsuit hands are opened at least half the time: AKo, AQo, KQo, AJo, KJo, QJo, ATo. KTo and A9o are mixed in rarely.



The suited bias

Every suited ace, suited kings down to K5s, suited connectors down to 65s and small pairs 33+. These hands set up straights, flushes and sets.

22.1%

of hands

Your charts start at 80bb. At 150bb (the webinar's example) the same idea is stronger still: even fewer offsuit hands and more small pairs and suited connectors.

Lojack open · 80bb → 20bb · your charts

THE SHALLOW SHIFT: SAME SIZE, DIFFERENT HANDS

STACK DEPTH

DEEP — SHALLOW

Folded: playability

30 combos removed.

K6s, K5s, JTo, 76s, 65s, 54s, 44, 33. Small pairs, small suited connectors and weak suited kings lose their implied odds.

In both · Removed · Added

AA	AKs	AQs	AJs	ATs	A9s	A8s	A7s	A6s	A5s	A4s	A3s	A2s
AKo	KK	KQs	KJs	KTs	K9s	K8s	K7s	~~K6s~~	~~K5s~~	K4s	K3s	K2s
AQo	KQo	QQ	QJs	QTs	Q9s	Q8s	Q7s	Q6s	Q5s	Q4s	Q3s	Q2s
AJo	KJo	QJo	JJ	JTs	J9s	J8s	J7s	J6s	J5s	J4s	J3s	J2s
ATo	KTo	QTo	~~JTo~~	TT	T9s	T8s	T7s	T6s	T5s	T4s	T3s	T2s
A9o	K9o	Q9o	J9o	T9o	99	98s	97s	96s	95s	94s	93s	92s
A8o	K8o	Q8o	J8o	T8o	98o	88	87s	86s	85s	84s	83s	82s
A7o	K7o	Q7o	J7o	T7o	97o	87o	77	~~76s~~	75s	74s	73s	72s
A6o	K6o	Q6o	J6o	T6o	96o	86o	76o	66	~~65s~~	64s	63s	62s
A5o	K5o	Q5o	J5o	T5o	95o	85o	75o	65o	55	~~54s~~	53s	52s
A4o	K4o	Q4o	J4o	T4o	94o	84o	74o	64o	54o	44	43s	42s
A3o	K3o	Q3o	J3o	T3o	93o	83o	73o	63o	53o	43o	~~33~~	32s
A2o	K2o	Q2o	J2o	T2o	92o	82o	72o	62o	52o	42o	32o	22

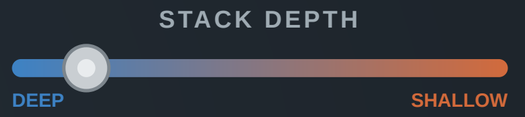
Added: top-pair power

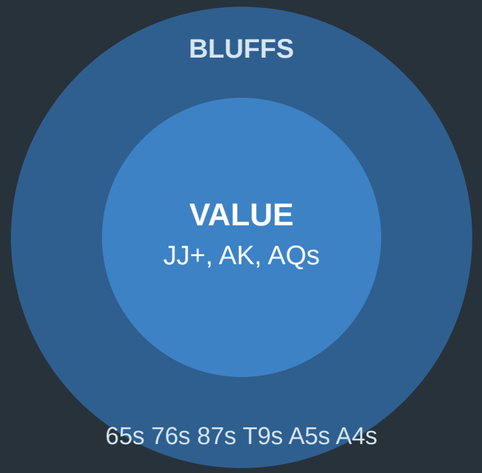
27 combos added.

Q8s, J8s, KTo, QTo, A9o, 87s. Offsuit Broadways and offsuit aces make top pairs you can stack off with.

22.1% at 80bb ≈ **21.9%** at 20bb. Not tighter: **different**. At 50bb the shift is part-way: 33 out; J8s, JTo, A9o, 87s in.

3-BETTING: THE DEEP-STACK STRATEGY





Webinar example: about 44 value combos and 36 bluff combos, so the range is balanced.

WHY SUITED CONNECTORS AND WHEEL ACES?



If you 3-bet only JJ+ and AK, a 5-6-7 flop misses you completely and opponents can attack it. Bluffs like 65s, 76s and A5s/A4s make straights, two pairs and wheels on those boards, so you're **much harder to exploit** on low, connected flops.

Your 80bb BTN vs LJ chart agrees: it 3-bets A2s 95%, 65s 75%, 87s 60% and T9s 50% of the time as bluffs.

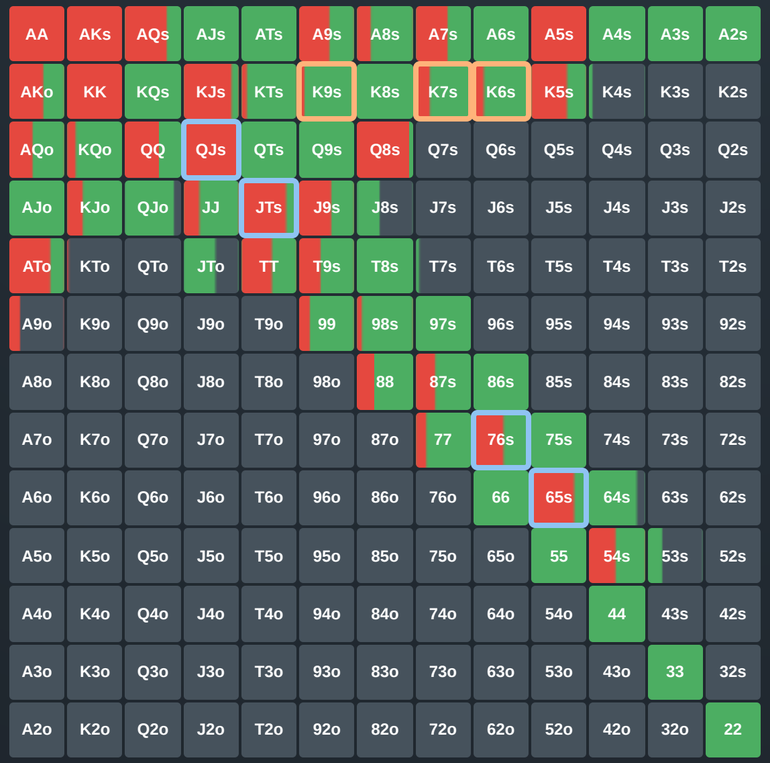
Button vs a lojack open · PokerCoaching charts at 100bb and 40bb

3-BETTING: WHAT CHANGES FROM 100BB TO 40BB

STACK DEPTH

DEEP — SHALLOW

100bb

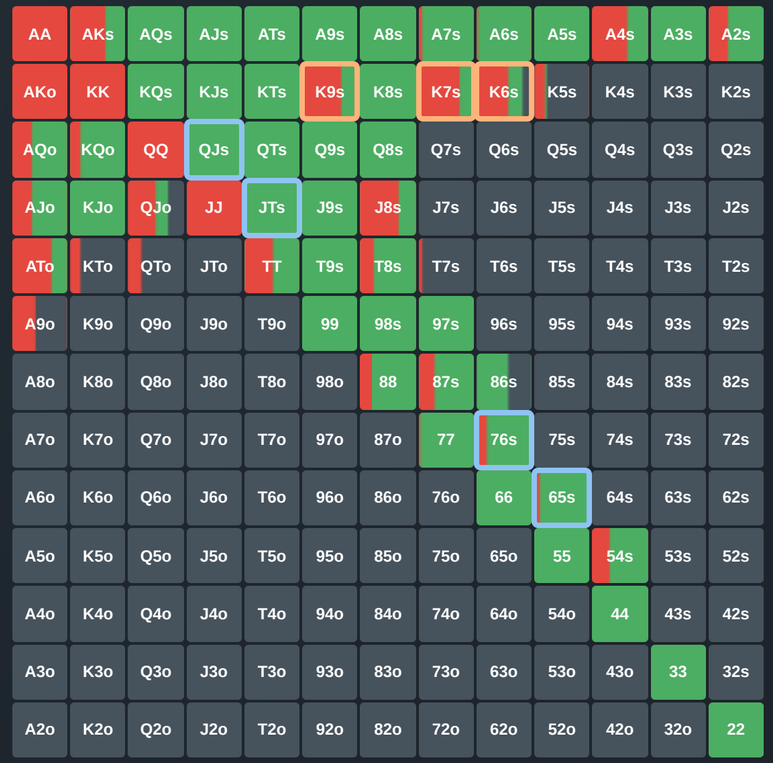


3-bet Call Fold

HAND	3-BET AT 100BB	AT 40BB
K9s	10%	71%
K7s	26%	74%
K6s	20%	58%
QJs	100%	0%
JTs	82%	0%
65s	76%	11%
76s	56%	20%

3-bet deep, flat at 40bb Flat deep, 3-bet at 40bb

40bb

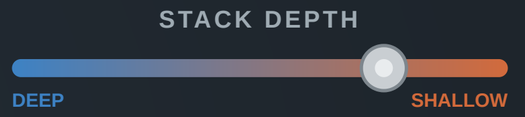


100bb: QJs, JTs, 65s and 76s are 3-bets. Deep, a 3-bet pot is big and still has room to play, so you want hands that make straights and flushes and cover low and middle boards. K9s–K6s just call: they make second-best flushes and weak top pairs, which are costly in big pots.

40bb: the lojack can 4-bet jam over your 3-bet, so the bluffs become K9s, K7s and K6s: the king blocks KK and AK, and they fold easily to a jam. QJs, JTs, 65s and 76s now just call: in position at 40bb they play well postflop and hate being jammed off their equity.

Button vs a middle-position open at 50bb

THE 3-BET BLUFF PARADOX: KTO VS KQO



Middle position opens · you're on the button

3-bet **KTo**

↓

They fold **better** hands: KJ, KQ, and AT

↓

Win: you fold out hands with about 70% equity against you

3-bet **KQo**

↓

They fold the hands you **dominate** (KJ, KT) and continue with hands that crush you (AK, AQ, big pairs)

↓

Loss: you've removed the hands you wanted to play against

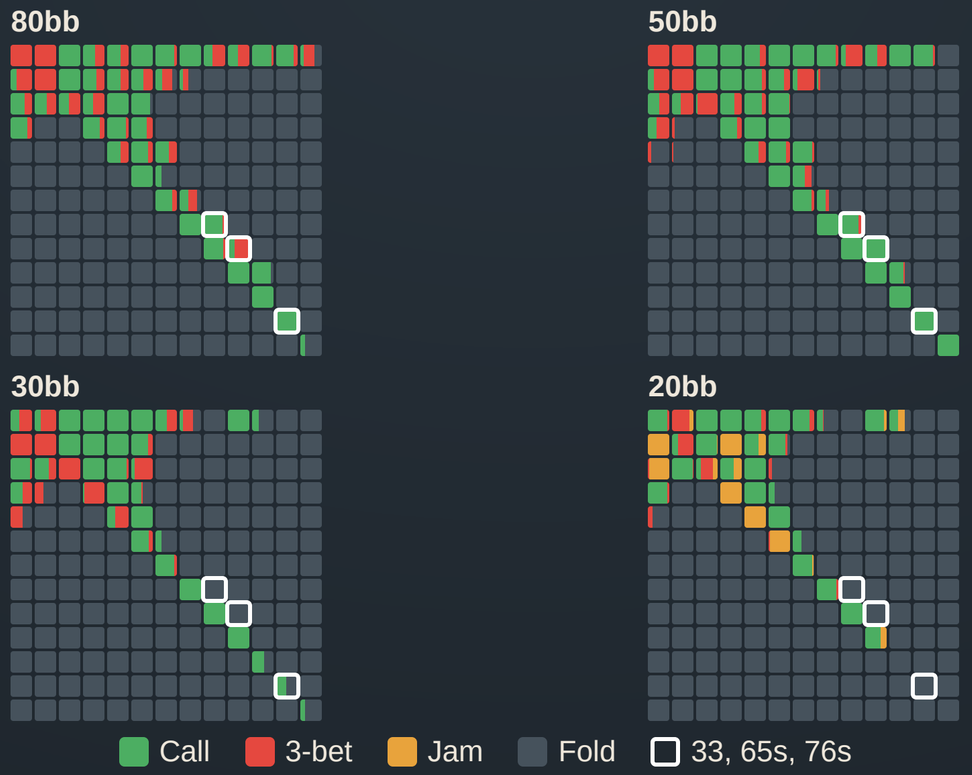
Flat KQo to keep dominated hands in the pot. 3-bet KTo to fold out better hands.

UTG opens · folds to the cutoff · your charts

CALLING AN OPEN: DEEP YES, SHALLOW NO

STACK DEPTH

DEEP — SHALLOW



HAND	80BB	50BB	30BB	20BB
33	Call	Call	Call 45% · Fold 55%	Fold
65s	Call 30% · 3-bet 70%	Call 95% · 3-bet 5%	Fold	Fold
76s	Call 85% · 3-bet 15%	Call 80% · 3-bet 20%	Fold	Fold
Behind ÷ call	**34×**	**22×**	**12×**	**9×**

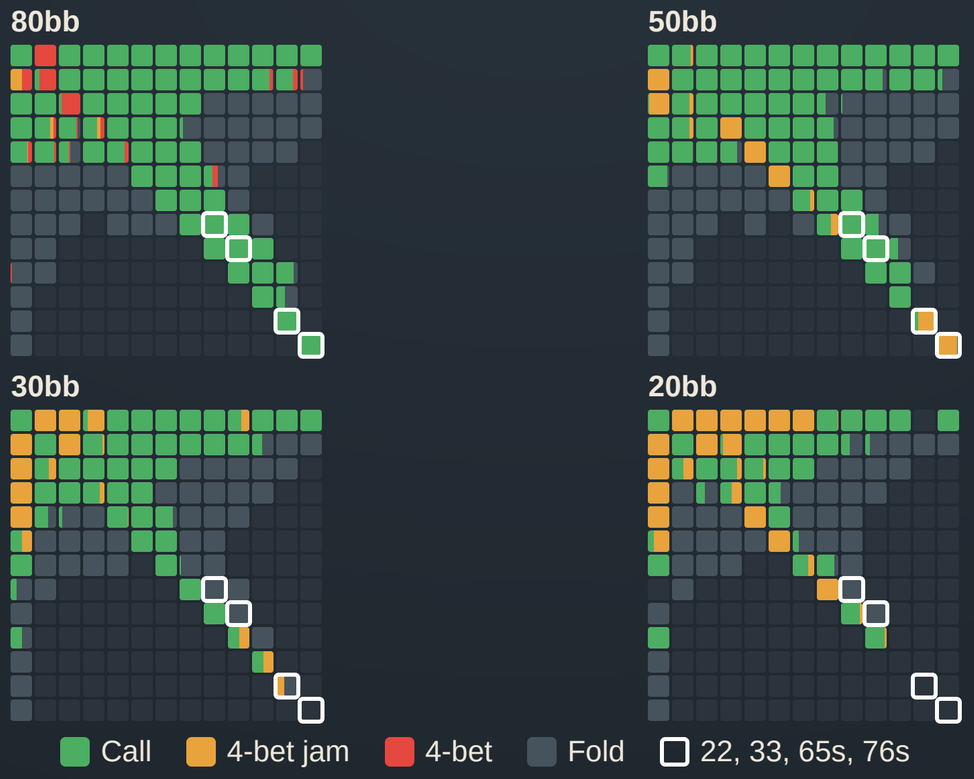
Calling an open with a small pair or suited connector is a bet on making a big hand and getting paid. With 50bb+ there's 20–35 times the call behind, comfortably above the **15–20×** set-mining needs. At 30bb (12×) and 20bb (9×) there isn't, and players left to act can squeeze you off the hand, so only 55+ keeps calling.

Button opens · big blind 3-bets · button decides · your charts

CALLING A 3-BET: THE DEEPER, THE MORE YOU CALL

STACK DEPTH

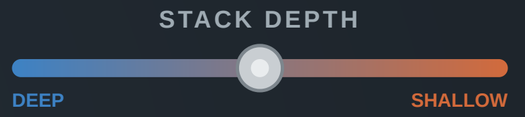
DEEP — SHALLOW



HAND	80BB	50BB	30BB	20BB
22	Call	Jam 90% · Fold 10%	Not opened	Open-jams instead
33	Call	Call 20% · Jam 80%	Jam 35% · Fold 65%	Open-jams instead
65s	Call	Call	Fold	Fold
76s	Call	Call	Fold	Fold
Behind ÷ call	**9×**	**6×**	**4×**	**3×**

Pure set-mining needs roughly **15–20 times** the call still behind (you flop a set about 1 time in 8.5). At 80bb, in position, there's about 9× plus the hands' other equity, so they call. At 50bb (6×) small pairs switch to **4-bet jams**; by 30bb (4×) suited connectors fold too.

THE ENGINE OF PLAYABILITY: STACK-TO-POT RATIO



SPR = effective stack behind ÷ pot on the flop

SPR 13+	SPR 7–13	SPR 4–7	SPR 2–4	SPR 0–2
Nut hands only	**Two pair or sets**	**Top pair: be careful**	**Top pair, overpair**	**Any pair, good draw**
Sets, straights, flushes	One pair = pot control	Good kicker can play a big pot	Plan to get it in	Already committed

13 100bb single-raised **8** 50bb single-raised **4.5** 30bb single-raised · 100bb 3-bet pot **3.3** 20bb single-raised **2.2** 50bb 3-bet pot

Each band shows the weakest hand usually strong enough to stack off (rough guide). Typical SPRs from your charts and solves, with a 1bb big-blind ante.

40bb deep · KQo vs a button caller · flop K-8-4

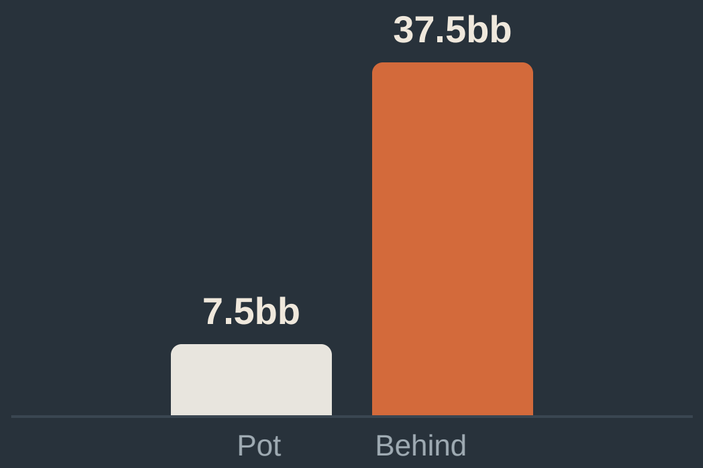
THE COMMITMENT ZONE: SPR 5 OR LESS

STACK DEPTH

DEEP — SHALLOW

FLOP

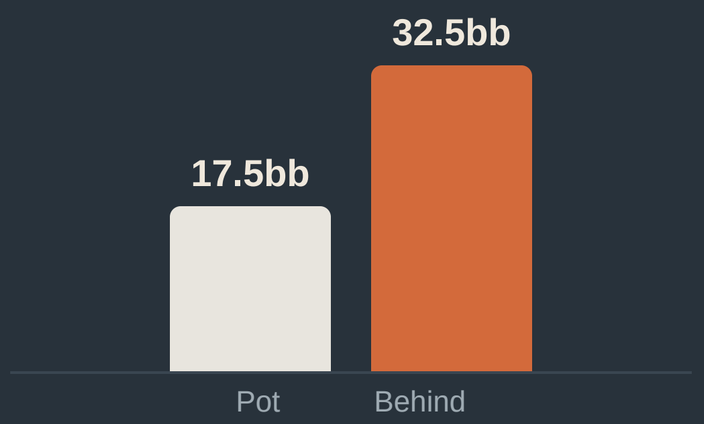
After a 2.5bb open and call



Flop SPR = 5

TURN

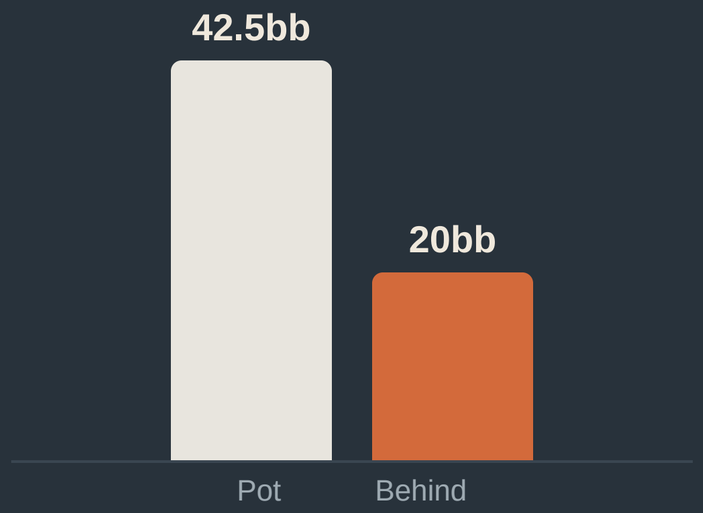
After you bet 5bb, called



Turn SPR ≈ 1.9

RIVER

After you bet 12.5bb, called

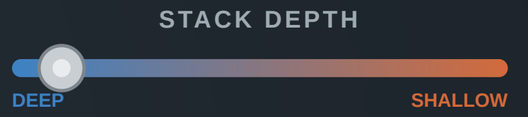


River SPR ≈ 0.5

With 20bb left and 42.5bb in the pot, a half-pot shove gets it all in. Normal-sized bets commit a 40bb stack with one strong top pair. At this depth, stronger hands (AQ, sets, two pairs) usually raise earlier, so KQ is near the top of what's left.

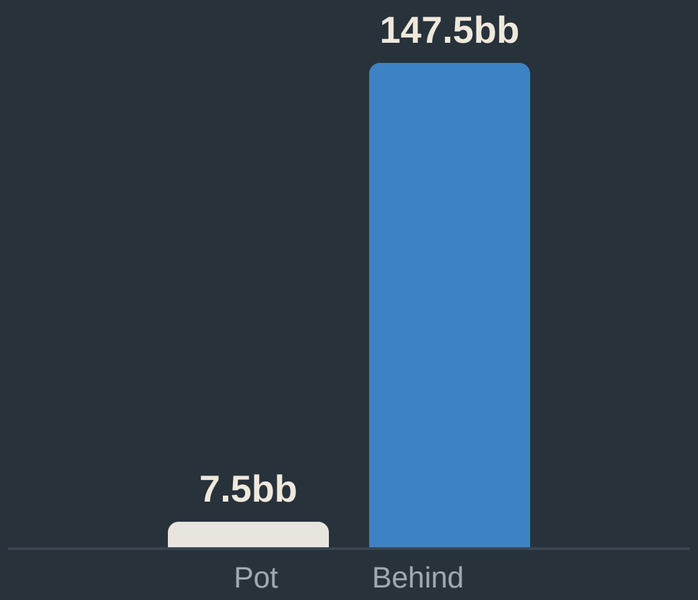
150bb deep · same hand, same bets

THE MANEUVER ZONE: SPR ABOVE 5



FLOP

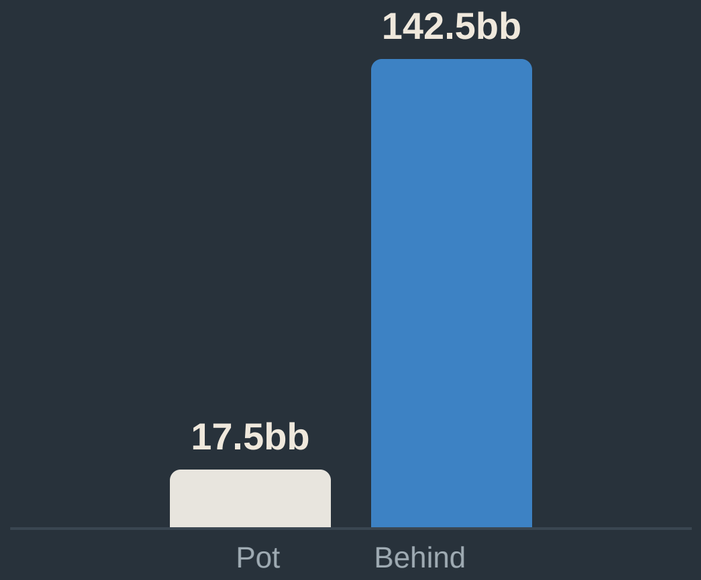
After a 2.5bb open and call



Flop SPR ≈ 20

TURN

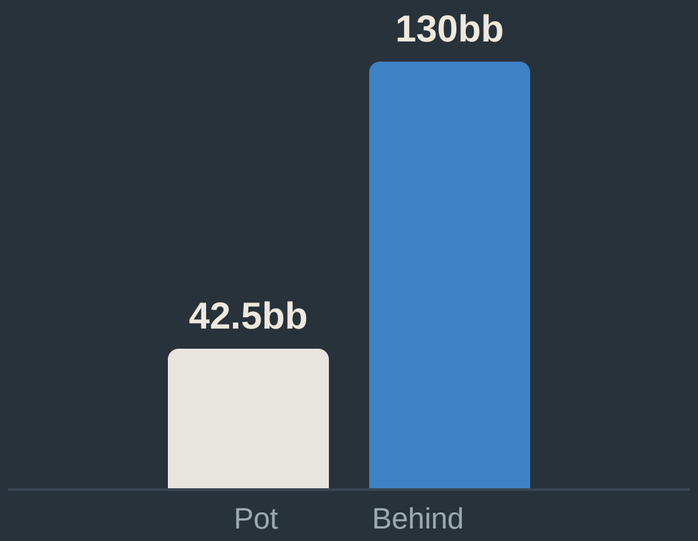
After you bet 5bb, called



Turn SPR ≈ 8

RIVER

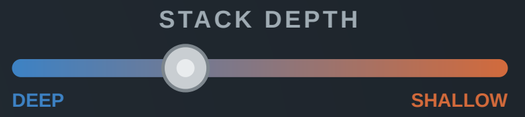
After you bet 12.5bb, called

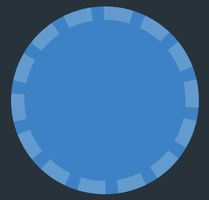


River SPR ≈ 3

Same bets, but 130bb are still behind on the river. You can't get stacks in without large overbets, and opponents have the implied odds to float and draw. Their calling range includes AQ, sets, two pairs and straights that would have raised earlier when shallow, so top pair is vulnerable.

THE MULTIWAY MODIFIER





Heads-up

150bb · pot 7.5bb · SPR ≈ 20

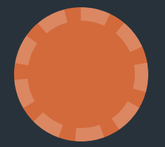
→



Open + 3 callers

3bb × 4 + blinds and ante ≈ 13.5bb pot

→



Multiway

SPR ≈ 11: plays shallower

The math

More players in the pot means a bigger pot for the same stacks, so a lower SPR, even at 150bb.

The shift

Strong top pairs and overpairs gain value, but so do opponents' two pairs and sets: with more players, someone has hit more often. Bluff less.

Example

Deep, with two early limpers, **over-limp** 44 behind them rather than isolate: it hates most flops and wants a cheap set. Don't open-limp from early position.

EFFECTIVE STACKS AND OPPONENT TENDENCIES

THE EFFECTIVE STACK RULE

100bb vs 25bb = 25bb

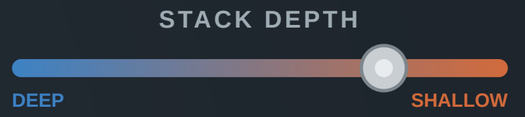
The effective stack is the smaller stack **in the hand**: it's the most you can win or lose. With 100bb against a 25bb player, play a 25bb strategy against them. Against another 100bb player, you're deep again. Use the stacks of the players who can enter the pot, not the table average.

ADJUST TO OPPONENTS

They fold too much to 3-bets	3-bet more blocker bluffs
They call 3-bets with weak hands	Drop the bluffs; 3-bet more value hands
They 4-bet jam only premiums	Fold AQ, AJs, KQs to the jam
They open too tight	3-bet less
They open too wide	3-bet and re-jam more

You are in the big blind · your charts

THE RE-JAM ZONE (20–35BB)



BIG BLIND FACING AN OPEN: IT DEPENDS WHO OPENED

HAND	80BB vs BTN	30BB vs UTG	30BB vs HJ	30BB vs CO	30BB vs BTN
AQo	3-bet	Call	Re-jam 70%	Re-jam	Re-jam
TT	3-bet	3-bet 55%	Re-jam 80%	Re-jam 85%	Re-jam 85%
66	Call 85%	Call 90%	3-bet 60%	Re-jam 85%	Re-jam
ATo	Call	Call 75%	Call	Call	Re-jam
A5s	Call 55%	Call	Call	Call	Call
KJo	Call 90%	Call	Call	Call	Call

Each cell shows the main action and how often your chart takes it (no % means always); the rest of the time it mixes in another play.

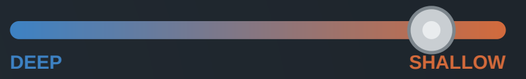
THE PATTERN

- **Deep, you 3-bet small or call.** At 80bb nothing in this table re-jams.
- **At 30bb, the later the opener, the more you re-jam.** A button or cutoff opens a wide range that can't call a jam, so 66, ATo and AQo shove against them.
- **Against an early opener, mostly call.** UTG's tight range calls a jam with the hands that crush you, so 66, ATo and even AQo usually just call.
- **Hands that play well after the flop but can't call a jam** (A5s, KJo) call at every position.
- Overall vs a button open: small 3-bets drop from 16% to 6% of hands; re-jams rise from 0% to 11%.

Your charts

CALLING ALL-INS: TIGHTER THAN JAMMING

STACK DEPTH



BIG BLIND FACING A BUTTON OPEN-SHOVE

HAND	20BB SHOVE	12BB SHOVE
A8o	Call	Call
QJo	Call 60%	Call
KJo	Call 40%	Call
KTo	Fold	Call
K9s	Fold	Call
22	Fold	Call

Call wider against **shorter** shoves: the price is better and their range is wider.

BUTTON FACING A BIG-BLIND RE-JAM

HAND	50BB RE-JAM	20BB RE-JAM
AJo	Call 80%	Call
ATo	Fold 80%	Call
A9o	Fold	Call
KQo	Fold	Call
66	Fold 65%	Call
KJo	Fold	Fold

You opened every one of these, but you call a 50bb re-jam with far fewer: you need a hand **ahead of their jamming range**, not just a playable one.

PUSH OR FOLD (15BB AND UNDER)

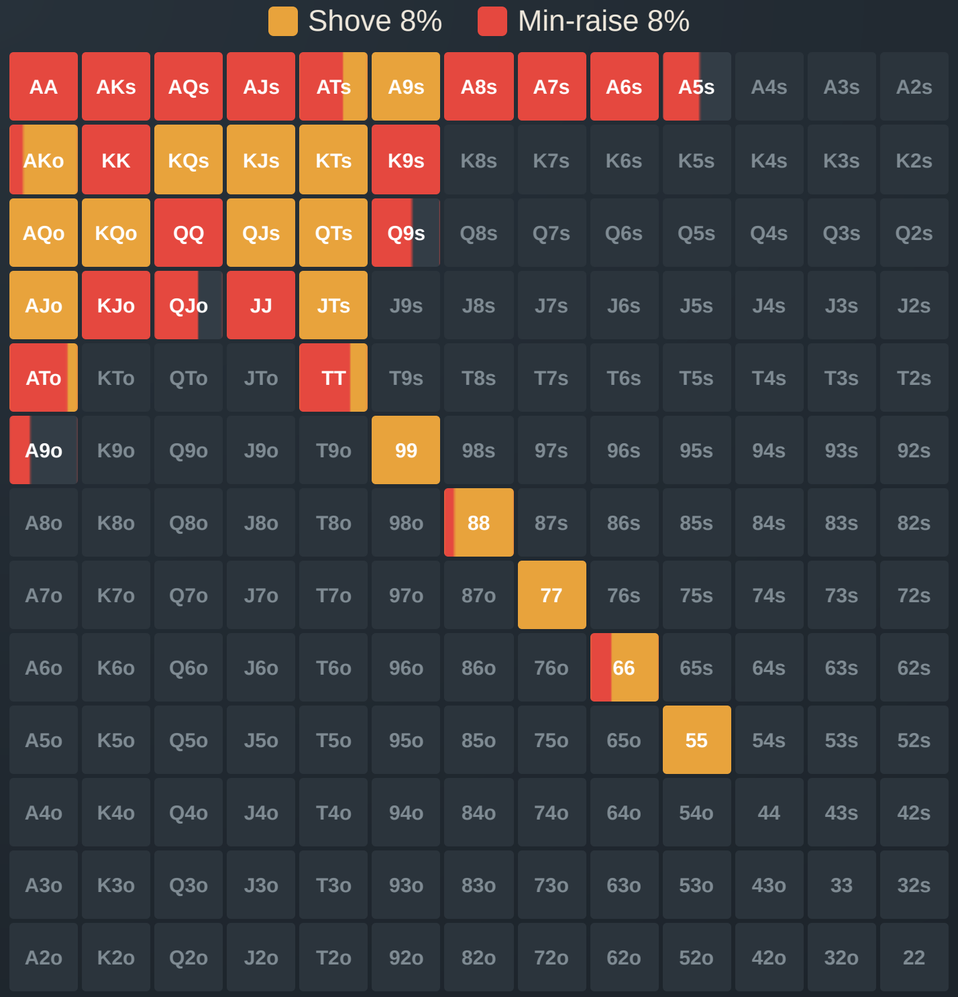
STACK DEPTH

DEEP — SHALLOW

Two-way opens at 12bb

Min-raise the best hands (AA–TT, the best suited aces) so they get action, plus a few that can fold.

Shove the middle: small and medium pairs, offsuit aces and Broadways. They win most when everyone folds and hate being re-jammed.



UTG open · 12bb · your chart

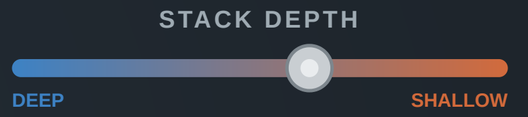
Under 10bb

Shove or fold. Each orbit costs about 2.5bb, so shove before you're too short to make anyone fold.

Shove wider the later your seat and the shorter your stack.

Bubble · you have 10bb in the big blind · the 40bb small blind shoves any two cards

THE BUBBLE: WHY YOU CALL LESS



SAME HAND, DIFFERENT ANSWER

YOUR HAND	EQUITY VS ANY TWO	NORMAL: NEED 43%	BUBBLE: NEED ~56%
55	61%	Call	Call
A8o	60%	Call	Call
K9o	58%	Call	Call
QJo	58%	Call	Call
K7o	55%	Call	Fold
A2o	55%	Call	Fold
33	53%	Call	Fold
97s	49%	Call	Fold

Normally you call 9bb to win 21bb, so 43% equity is enough. On the bubble, busting costs you a sure min-cash and doubling up doesn't double your prize, so you need roughly 12% more.

MORE EXAMPLES

- **QQ vs AK** with two big stacks: QQ is only about 55%, but with both players cashing comfortably you'd need around 70%. **Fold.**
- **Big stack vs a short stack's jam:** losing barely dents you, so call about as wide as normal.
- **Medium stack vs another medium stack:** the most dangerous all-in on the bubble. Avoid it without a premium.
- **As the big stack,** open and shove wider: medium stacks have to fold too much.
- **Your charts ignore payouts:** on the bubble, call tighter than the charts.

THE MASTER STACK-DEPTH MATRIX

	100bb+ Maneuver	**40–60bb** Top pair	**20–35bb** Re-jam	**15bb and under** Push/fold
Single-raised pot SPR	13+	About 6–8	About 3–4.5	About 2 (after a min-raise)
Main priority	Making the nuts; pot control with one pair	Strong top pairs	High cards, blockers, fold equity	All-in equity
Opens gain	Small pairs, suited connectors, suited aces	KJo, KTo, JTo, ATo, A9o	Same %, smaller sizes; BTN tightens	Shoves: pairs, Ax, Broadways
3-bet bluffs	65s, 76s, 87s, T9s, A5s, A4s	ATo, AJo, KJo, KTo, A9s–A6s	Re-jams with blockers (Ax, Kx)	Re-jam or fold
Top pair	Pot control; vulnerable to floats	Strong; stacks off in 3-bet pots	Usually a stack-off	Get it in

Numbers come from your PokerCoaching charts (80bb is the deepest they go) and the solved spots in the drills. Ideas also from PokerCoaching videos by Matt Affleck (stack depth) and Jonathan Little (bubble). Full details: the Stack Depth & Bubble Strategy player's guide.